

THE PAYSON MORNING SCROLL

MADE EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE MOGOLLON'S HEARTH GUESTS

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

THE GREYBEARDS OF HIGH HROTHGAR — PUBLISHER & PROPRIETOR

PAYSON, ARIZONA · MORNDAS, THE 5TH OF FROSTFALL (MONDAY, OCTOBER 5, 2026) · MORNING EDITION — VOL. 2610, No. 05
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*Gandy soaks up the sun while
Maevy declares war on a
butterfly.*

SKIES O'ER THE HOLD

80° / 56°

Sunny

Sunrise 6:23 AM · Sunset 6:03 PM

Tomorrow — Sunny, 83/58

OVERHEARD LAST NIGHT

*A traveler come down from the Rim asked
the barkeep why the whole forest smells of
rain on a dry morning. The barkeep only
shrugged: "Aye. The storms left last week,
but the pines remember."*

THE MOON'S RECKONING



Yesterday



Tonight
Last Quarter



Tomorrow
Waning Crescent

waning toward the new moon

5th of Frostfall = October 5

Months run one-for-one all year

Sundas=Sun ... Loredas=Sat

AROUND THE HOLDS · THE WEEK AHEAD

A Week of Wheels, Homecomings, and Fine Art



Payson, Ariz.



Daybreak over the Mogollon Rim, as seen by our staff engraver.

HAIL and good Morndas to thee, wayfarer — the sun climbs over the Rim on a clear golden morning, the

pinos still sweet with last week's rain, and the Holds stir for a week of wheels and wonder. Friday the iron carriages roll into Payson: the 33rd annual Beeline Cruise-

In takes over Green Valley Park, three days of gleaming horseless wagons (other travelers have called them 'automobeels') with raffles for local charities and no admission to pay. Down in Camp Verde, old Fort Verde throws open its gates for Fort Verde Days, the fort's grand homecoming, free both days. And Sedona hangs a hundred artists' finest against the red rocks for the 35th annual Sedona Arts Festival. Lace up thy boots and go — the week will not wait.

HAPPENING IN THE HOLDS TODAY

-  **Payson**
 - **Mobile Business Services @ Payson** — the AZ Secretary of State's mobile office for business filings, 9 AM–3 PM (lunch 12–1), Payson Public Library, 328 N McLane Rd
-  **Sedona**
 - **Olive Oil Tasting** — guided tasting, 4 PM, 336 AZ-179 #c102
-  **Prescott**
 - **Monday BINGO** — weekly bingo night, 6 PM, the Jersey Lilly mead hall, 116 S Montezuma St

THE DAYS AHEAD

- **Tue, Oct. 6**
 - **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — 7 AM–noon, off AZ-87 just before Pine. PINE-Strawberry Fuel Reduction's volunteer trail-build day: clear brush, move rocks, and shape trail — tools provided, no experience needed, bring water, gloves, and sturdy shoes. The work doubles as fire-safety access for crews; email trails@psfuelreduction.org to join.
- **Thu, Oct. 8**
 - **FBI Cybersecurity Seminar** — 10 AM, Payson Public Library, 328 N McLane Rd. The library's own calendar lists a cybersecurity seminar from the FBI — learn to dodge the internet's pickpockets from the realm's own watchmen. To register for library events, call (928) 474-9260.

— **Windmill Park Farmers Market** — 2 PM, 9950 E Cornville Rd, Cornville. A midweek farmers market in the Verde Valley with local produce and vendors — a fine excuse for a Thursday drive.

• Fri, Oct. 9

— **Beeline Cruise-In: Friday Cruise + Burger Burn** — the cruise leaves Rumsey Park at 3:30 PM and rolls around NW Payson; the Burger Burn fires up in Rumsey Park. Kickoff night for the 33rd annual Cruise-In weekend; both days' events are free to the public.

— **Prescott Antique Show & Vintage Market — Early Bird** — 2–6 PM, Prescott Rodeo Grounds. Early-bird shopping (\$15) ahead of Saturday's main market at the twice-yearly antique market hosted by the Yavapai and Thumb Butte Questers; proceeds fund local historic preservation.

• Sat–Sun, Oct. 10–11

— **33rd Annual Beeline Cruise-In Classic Car Show** — Saturday 8 AM–3 PM, Green Valley Park, Payson. The weekend's main event: classic cars, trucks, rat rods, and low riders gleaming on the grass, with raffles raising money for local charities, food vendors, and entertainment by the Town of Payson. Free to the public.

— **Fort Verde Days** — 10 AM–4 PM both days, Fort Verde State Historic Park, 125 E Hollamon St, Camp Verde. Camp Verde's annual homecoming and biggest weekend of the year: Saturday's downtown parade at 10 AM, living-history re-enactors, artillery demonstrations, military drills, Dutch-oven cooking, a vintage baseball game, pony rides, food and craft vendors, and live music. Free admission to the fort both days.

— **35th Annual Sedona Arts Festival** — Sat 9 AM–5 PM, Sun 10 AM–4 PM, Sedona Red Rock High School, 995 Upper Red Rock Loop Rd, West Sedona. Sedona's oldest and largest fine-arts event: more than 100 juried artists from across the country, live music, food trucks, a beer and wine garden, and Gourmet Row of locally made goods, all against the red rocks. Admission \$5 a day.

A HOMECOMING AT THE FORT

Fort Verde Days



Homecoming at the old fort: drills, artillery, and nine innings beside the palisade.

Camp Verde's biggest weekend of the year is here: Fort Verde Days, the old fort's annual homecoming, runs Saturday and Sunday, Oct. 10–11, 10 AM–4 PM daily at Fort Verde State Historic Park, 125 E Hollamon St.

Saturday opens with the downtown parade at 10 AM, then the fort fills with living-history re-enactors, artillery demonstrations, military drills, Dutch-oven cooking demos, a vintage baseball game, pony rides, food and craft vendors, and live music.

Admission to the fort is free both days — bring the whole party, Valley Dwellers and all, as they trade the lowland heat for Rim Country air.

Free admission to the fort both days · Sat–Sun, Oct. 10–11, 10 AM–4 PM · Fort

Verde State Historic Park, 125 E Hollamon St, Camp Verde

Why go: Two days of living history, cannon thunder, and small-town homecoming cheer — the friendliest weekend Camp Verde throws all year.

QUESTS OF THE HEARTH

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Measure the flame bulb and socket, find or design a wall-torch sconce model scaled to seat the bulb right, and slice a small socket test piece in PETG — due Sept. 26, now overdue.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Print two torches plus the socket test piece, then test-fit the bulb and socket before any finishing — due Oct. 3, now overdue.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Paint faux wrought iron or wood, UV-seal, wire the sockets into the door-light boxes (breaker OFF), mount both torches, and test at dusk — due Oct. 10.



The sconce bench: two torches taking shape, and the flame bulbs waiting their turn.

The torch-sconce quests run overdue — finish the design, and the Hearth's torchlight can rise.

MERCHANT OF THE HOLD

Indian Gardens Cafe & Market · Sedona



The garden courtyard at its busiest: travelers fed, mugs steaming, the canyon looking on.

A Sedona and Oak Creek Canyon landmark, Indian Gardens is a garden-side café and market tucked into the canyon pines along AZ-89A — order at the counter and they bring breakfast or lunch to thy table on the leafy garden patio. The menu runs from the famous breakfast burrito (avocado inside, with a salsa more like a mole) to the bacon-and-brie sandwich, fresh pastries, and strong coffee; the little market stocks local goods for the road. The garden grows impossibly green against the red rock — some patient earth-magic, the old-timers say — and the drive down from the Hearth drops off the Mogollon Rim into the Verde Valley, worth a rein-pull and a likeness snared in thy pocket-glass (other travelers have called it a ‘celliephone’).

“Good food in an incredible setting. Reasonable prices for Sedona.” — [TripAdvisor review](#)

3951 N State Route 89A, Sedona (up Oak Creek Canyon); open daily 8 AM–4 PM; (928) 282-7702; \$\$ moderate. Good to know: the garden patio is dog-friendly and fills fast after morning hikes — come hungry and expect a short line at the counter. · [their scrying-mirror page](#) (other travelers call it a ‘website’)

Why the Hearth sends you: The Hearth sends thee here for the single finest garden breakfast in the red-rock country — a canyon-side feast where even the pines lean in to watch thee eat.

TALES FROM THE TREELINE

THE SUNBEAM CORONATION



Earl naps on, unmoved — even a pine-cone crown cannot disturb his dignity.

Earl (an elk with enormous antlers) takes his dignity seriously, and this fine sunny morning he took it straight to the Hearth’s front deck, where one perfect sunbeam lay across the planks like a warm rug. He lowered himself into it with great ceremony, folded his legs, and announced that he would be napping, and was not to be disturbed.

Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) took this as an invitation to help. He fetched a pine bough to fan the great napping elk — “for the flies,” he said proudly — and waved it so enthusiastically that the first pine cone dropped straight onto Earl’s nose.

Earl did not move. Dignity, he has always maintained, is staying put.

The second cone bounced off one antler. The third landed in the crook of the other and stayed there, like a small brown crown.

Mabel (a wood elf) came out with the washing, took one look, and said what everyone was thinking: “Well. It suits him.”

Earl opened one eye, considered the crown, and went back to sleep. Some nappers get pine needles. Earl got a coronation.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Morndas be free of giants, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ☒